

Evaluating analyses of the Conjunct Constraint with its violations

Zheng Shen

National University of Singapore

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Coordinate Structure Constraint and Conjunct Constraint

- Coordinate Structure Constraint (CSC):
 - **Conjunct Constraint** (CC): Conjuncts cannot be moved.
 - 1) ***What** did Mary buy [*t* and a book about linguistics]?
 - **Element Constraint** (EC): No element contained in a conjunct can be moved out of that conjunct.
 - 2) ***What** did Mary buy [a photo of *t*] and a book about linguistics?
- Grosu 1973, Oda 2021: CC and EC are distinct constraints and should be analyzed separately.
- We will focus on (two recent analyses of) the CC today.

The Category Transfer analysis (Zhang 2010)

- CC is further split into CCE and CCI:
- Assuming the structure: [Ce [and Ci]]
- CCI: ban on movement of the second/internal conjunct
 - 3) *What did Mary buy [a photo and]?
 - Zhang: coordinators do not allow their complements to be moved or deleted.
- CCE: ban on movement of the first/external conjunct
 - 4) *What did Mary buy [and a book]?
 - Zhang: Category Transfer analysis based on CCE-violating movement in Mandarin.

The Category Transfer analysis (Zhang 2010)

- Assumption: Any moved element must have categorial features.
- Coordinators like *and* in English can coordinate DPs, PPs, VPs, etc, indicating that they do not have categorial features.
- In this case, the external/first conjunct transfers its feature to the coordinator and becomes immobile.
- $[C1_{[+N]} \text{ and } [\emptyset] C2_{[+N]}] \rightarrow [C1_{[\emptyset]} \text{ and } [+N] C2_{[+N]}] \rightarrow C1_{[\emptyset]}$ is immobile

The Category Transfer analysis (Zhang 2010)

- Argument: *he/gen* in Mandarin Chinese can only conjoin nominals, thus have their own categorial feature [+N].
- C1 retains its categorial feature thus can be moved.
- In the sentences below, the first conjunct moves out of the conjunction.
 - 5) *Huochē* hui [*t* gen qiche] xiangzhuang ma? (Zhang 2010, ex. 85a)
火車 會 跟汽車 相撞 嗎?
train will [*t* and car] collide Q ‘Will the train and the car collide?’
 - 6) *Akiu* zai Riben [*t* gen Baoyu] jian-le mian. (Zhang 2010, ex. 90b)
阿Q在日本 跟 寶玉 見了面
Akiu in Japan [*t* and Baoyu] meet-LE face ‘Akiu and Baoyu met up in Japan.’
- Prediction: CC-violating movement of C1 is possible **only** for coordinators with categorial features.
- Note that the categorial feature on the coordinator is a necessary but not a satisfactory condition for CC-violating movement.

The Parallelism Requirement

- Fortuny 2024 (cf. Napoli 1993) proposes:
 - the Parallelism Requirement: Two syntactic constituents can be coordinated if and only if the categorial features are identical.
 - Fortuny proposes a generalized categorial feature system where [Foc], [Rel], and [Wh] (but not phi features) are categorial features
- The Requirement can account for CCo as the conjuncts would have different wh-features:
 - 7) *What did Mary buy [*t* and a photo]?
did Mary buy [what_[+wh] and a photo_[-wh]]?

The Parallelism Requirement

- Although Fortuny did not discuss CC-violating movement, the analysis predicts:
- CC-violating movement cannot be a movement that target any features.
- The Parallelism Requirement is also a necessary condition.

Predictions

- The Category Transfer analysis predicts **only coordinators without category restrictions** can allow CC-violating movement.
- The Parallelism Requirement analysis predicts **only movement that does not target features** can allow CC-violating movement.

CC-violating movement in BCMS

- Bosnian-Croatian-Montenegrin-Serbian (thereinafter BCMS) allows CC-violating movement.
- 8) ?*Knjige* je Marko [*t* i filmove] kupio.
Books is Marko [*t* and movies] bought
'Marko bought books and movies.' (Boskovic 2009, ex 30, see also Stjepanović 2014, Oda 2021)

CC-violating movement in BCMS

- Shen 2023 conducted a survey with 30 BCMS speakers

- (5) *Danas se sudaraju sablje i koplja u bici.*
today REFL collide.3PL.PRES sabers.FPL and spears.NPL in battle
'Sabers and spears are colliding in battle today.' (baseline)

Mean rating: 4.6, rating distribution: 5(23), 4(4), 3(1), 2(2), 1(0)

- (6) **Šta₁ se danas t₁ i koplja sudaraju u bici?*
what₁ REFL today t₁ and spears.NPL collide.3PL.PRES in battle?
'What and spears are colliding today in battle?' (CC-violating wh-movement)

Mean rating: 1.37, rating distribution: 5(1), 4(0), 3(2), 2(3), 1(24)

- (7) *%Sablje₁ se danas t₁ i koplja sudaraju u bici.*
sabers.FPL₁ REFL today t₁ and spears.NPL collide.3PL.PRES in battle
'Sabers and spears are colliding in battle today.' (CC-violating scrambling)

Mean rating: 2.6, rating distribution: 5(5), 4(4), 3(5), 2(6), 1(10)

- Observation 1: the coordinator is *i*
- Observation 2: wh-movement cannot violate the CC while scrambling can (for some speakers)

Implications for the Category Transfer analysis

- *The coordinator i* in BCMS can coordinate different phrases:

(8) Brown and Alt 2004, section 3.4.1

- a. *Ivan i njegova žena rade.*
Ivan and his wife work
'Ivan and his wife are working.' (conjoining NPs)
- b. *Živi i stvara u Ljubljani.*
work and live in Ljubljana
'He/she lives and works in Ljubljana.' (conjoining verbs)
- c. *Zauzet sam i ne mogu više slušati.*
busy am and not can more listen
'I am busy and I cannot listen any more.' (conjoining clauses)

Implications for the Category Transfer analysis

- CC-violating movement in BCMS thus challenges the cross-linguistic applicability of the Category Transfer analysis.
- It's also unclear how this analysis would account for the contrast between wh-movement and scrambling.

Implications for the Parallelism Requirement analysis

- The unavailability of CC-violating wh-movement is expected under the Parallelism analysis as one conjunct is [+wh] and the other is not.
- The availability of CC-violating scrambling is also expected:
 - Bailyn 2001, 2004 argues that in Slavic languages, local scrambling is driven by EPP, following Miyagawa 2003.
 - Scrambling does not require the conjuncts to have different features, the Parallelism Requirement is thus not violated.

Further evidence for the wh/scrambling contrast

- Data collected from 5 speakers confirms the wh vs. scrambling contrast:

9) ***Koje sablje** se danas i **ta koplja** sudaraju u bici? (1.8/5)
What sabers aux today and **those spears** collided in battle
'What sabers and those spears collided in battle today?'

10) **Koje sablje** se danas i **koja koplja** sudaraju u bici? (3.6)
What sabers aux today and **what spears** collided in battle
'What sabers and what spears collided in battle today?'

- Moving a wh conjunct is OK as long as the other conjunct is also wh.

Back to CC-violating movement in Mandarin

- Note that the CC-violating movement in Mandarin from Zhang 2010 also does not involve obvious feature checking.
 - 5) Huoche hui [t gen qiche] xiangzhuang ma? (Zhang 2010, ex. 85a)
火車 會 跟汽車 相撞 嗎?
train will [and car] collide Q
'Will the train and the car collide?'
 - 6) Akiu zai Riben [t gen Baoyu] jian-le mian. (Zhang 2010, ex. 90b)
阿Q在日本 跟 寶玉 見了面
Akiu in Japan [t and Baoyu] meet-LE face
'Akiu and Baoyu met up in Japan.'

Back to CC-violating movement in Mandarin

- Zhang 2008 provides an example of CC-violating relativization:

9) [t Gen Daiyu he-zu fangzi de] xuesheng hen-qiong.

跟 黛玉 合租 房子 的 學生 很窮

[t and Daiyu co-rent house DE] student very-poor

‘The student who rents a house with Daiyu is poor.’ (Zhang:2008 ex 57)

- At the same time, Zhang 2008, 2010 argues that *liang-ge-ren* ‘two people’ ensure that the ‘A gen B’ string forms a constituent.

- Adding *liang-ge-ren* (兩個人) to (9) makes the sentence degraded:

10) *Gen Daiyu ***liang-ge-ren*** he-zu fangzi de xuesheng hen-qiong.

跟 黛玉 兩個人 合租 房子 的 學生 很窮

and Daiyu two-CL-people co-rent house DE student very-poor

Intended: ‘The student who rents a house together with Daiyu is poor.’

- *Gen Daiyu* in (9) might not be part of conjunction, thus (9) is not CC-violating relativization.

Back to CC-violating movement in Mandarin

- Adding *liang-ge-ren* to non feature probing CC-violating movement is OK:

11) Akiu zai Riben [gen Baoyu] ***liang-ge-ren*** jian-le mian.

阿Q在日本 跟 寶玉 兩個人 見了面

Akiu in Japan [t and Baoyu] two-CL-people meet-LE face

‘Akiu and Baoyu two of them met up in Japan.’

Interim Summary

- CC-violating movement in BCMS challenges the Category Transfer analysis for CCe.
- The Parallelism Requirement analysis correctly predicts the wh-movement/scrambling contrast.

A problem for Fortuny's Parallelism Requirement

- Fortuny proposes a generalized categorial feature system where [Foc], [Rel], and [Wh] (but not phi features) are categorial features.
- The ban on wh-movement out of conjunction is subsumed by the ban on coordinating phrases of difference categorial features.
- However, recent discussion established that the ban on coordinating phrases of difference categorial features **does not** hold:
 - 15) [[_{NP} That place] and [_{PP} behind these shops]] are where many families reside.
(Patejuk and Przepiórkowski, 2023, ex. 20)
 - 16) ...[[_{NP} with respect] and [_{AdvP} humanly]] is not how all of us treat our animals!
(Patejuk and Przepiórkowski, 2023, ex. 11')
- Note that the pseudocleft construction in (15-16) rules out the clausal ellipsis analysis of the sentences.

A modified Parallelism Requirement

- I propose a modified Parallelism Requirement:
 - 17) The Parallelism Requirement (modified): The conjuncts and the resulting coordinate structure are of the same **A'** features e.g. [Rel], [Foc], [Wh].
- Following van Urk 2015, A movement targets obligatory features while A' movement targets optional features, thus (17) can be implemented as (18)
 - 18) The Parallelism Requirement (modified): The conjuncts and the resulting coordinate structure are of the same **optional** features.
- (18) predicts that CC-violating movement cannot be movement that probes A'/optional features.

Evidence

- Shen 2023: CC-violating movement in BCMS feeds quantifier binding, suggesting A movement.

(23) a. Njegovi vojnici vole **svakog generala** i svoju zemlju.
his soldiers.NOM love **every.ACC general.ACC** and self's country.ACC

• 5/30 chose *the generals*

b. **Svakog generala₁** njegovi vojnici vole t_1 i svoju zemlju.
every.ACC general.ACC his soldiers.NOM love t and self's country.ACC
Bound variable reading: 'For every general, the general's soldiers love that general and the soldiers' country.'

• 25/30 chose *the generals*

(24) Čiji su vojnici? 'Whose soldiers are they?'
a. Generalovi. 'The generals'.' (bound variable reading)
b. Od nekog drugog. 'Someone else's.'

Challenges from cross-linguistic data?

- So far the proposal is supported by the data from Mandarin and BCMS.
- It would be ideal if the Requirement is universal.
- Oda 2021 reported/summarized CC-violating movement from several other languages.
 - Almost all are scrambling-like movement, compatible with the proposal.
 - But there are examples of movement of wh-elements as well:

Challenges from cross-linguistic data?

(19) Gitksan

Gwi-hl_i gubis Henry [**t_i** gan-hl miyup]?

what-CN eat.TRA.PN Henry and-CN rice

‘What did Henry eat and rice?’ (Davis & Brown 2011:58)

(20) Nisgha

Ksax **haxwadakw-hl_i** dii jabit, [**t_i** gan-hl hawil].

only bow-CN CNTR make-TRA-3SG.II and-CN arrow

‘He did nothing but make bows and arrows.’ (Tarpent 1987: 452)

(21) Shona

?**Ndi-Ø-ani_i** wa-v-aka-teng-er-a [**t_i** na-Ø-Tendai] ma-rokwe?

NI-1a-who 1a.NSE-2.SM-TA-buy-APPL-FV and-1a-Tendai 6-dress

‘Who(m)_i did they buy [**t_i** and Tendai] dresses?’ (Zentz 2016: 137)

- Forbes 2014 notes that in Gitksan (19) and Nisgha (20), *gan*+DP2 can be extraposed to sentence final.
- b. Ixw ’nisi’m ahl hiiluxw gant Lisa.
ixw [’nisi’m] a=hl hiiluxw [gan=t Lisa]
fish [2PL.III] OBL=DET morning [and =DET Lisa]
‘You and Lisa fished in the morning.’
- Forbes: that ‘*gan*+DP2’ adjoins to DP1 and can be extraposed.
- Zentz 2016: *na*- involves a “comitative construction”, instead of coordination.

Arano and Oda 2019: Japanese

- Arano and Oda 2019 notes CC-violating movement in Japanese does not feed (variable) binding, unlike BCMS.

- (10) a. Dareka-ga [san-bon-izyoo-no ronbun-to hon]-o yonda.
someone-NOM three-CL-more.than-GEN paper-and book-ACC read
'Someone read [[more than three papers] and books].' $\exists > \text{more than 3}; * \text{more than 3} > \exists$
- b. ?[San-bon-izyoo-no ronbun-to]₁ dareka-ga [t₁ hon]-o yonda.
three-CL-more.than-GEN paper-and someone-NOM book-ACC read
lit. '[More than three papers and]₁ someone read [t₁ books].' $\exists > \text{more than 3}; * \text{more than 3} > \exists$

- A&O 2019 thus argues that CC-violating movement is A' scrambling, potentially challenging the modified Parallelism.

Arano and Oda 2019: Japanese

- A&O: that scrambling that crosses a transfer domain (e.g. ConjP) shows A' properties in Japanese.
- CC-violating scrambling does not target optional features, so even that it shows A' properties, it does not falsify the Parallelism Requirement.
- Arano 2025 offers a different analysis and explicitly argues that CC-violating movement in Japanese is not feature driven.

Summary

- CC-violating movement provides support to the Parallelism Requirement analysis.
- The Parallelism Requirement restricts A'/optional features (instead of categorial features).
- Evidence from BCMS, Chinese, and other languages is compatible with the proposal.

What about wh-in-situ?

What about wh-in-situ: predictions

- The Parallelism Requirement:
 - If wh-element is [+wh], wh-in-situ of either conjunct is ruled out:
 - *[-wh and +wh] or *[+wh and -wh]
 - If wh-element is not [+wh], wh-in-situ should be OK: [-wh and -wh]
- Zhang 2010:
 - If wh-in-situ is covert movement:
 - wh-in-situ of the first conjunct should be bad (Category Transfer)
wh-in-situ of the second conjunct should be OK
 - If wh-in-situ is not movement (e.g. unselective binding):
 - wh-in-situ of the both conjuncts should be OK

What about wh-in-situ: intuitions

Mandarin:

12) Zai Riben [**shui** gen Baoyu] *liang-ge-ren* jian-le mian? 在日本誰跟寶玉兩個人見了面?
in Japan [who and Baoyu] two-CL-people meet-LE face
'Who and Baoyu two of them met up in Japan.'

13) Zai Riben [Baoyu gen **shui**] *liang-ge-ren* jian-le mian? 在日本寶玉跟誰兩個人見了面?
in Japan [who and Baoyu] two-CL-people meet-LE face
'Who and Baoyu two of them met up in Japan.'

- They sound OK to me, which is still compatible with the Parallelism Requirement:
- Given wh-elements can be used as indefinite (Li 1992), wh-elements might not be [+wh]

14) Ruguo ni tou-le **shenme**, jiu chengren ba 如果你偷了什麼，就承認吧。
If you stole what, just admit SFP
If you stole **something**, just admit it. (wh-indefinite)

What about wh-in-situ: experiments in Singlish

- Colloquial Singapore English (Singlish): a contact language with English lexifier and Chinese dialects, Malay and Tamil as substrate languages.
- It allows both wh-movement and wh-in-situ (Sato and Ngui 2017, Tan and Shen 2025)
 - 15) Where John can buy the durians?
 - 16) John can buy the durians where?
- Wh-elements in Singlish can also be used as indefinite in the wh-also construction (Lincoln 2024)
 - 17) What also Mary like to eat. ‘Mary likes to eat everything/anything.’
- We conducted two acceptability judgment experiments, one on the first conjunct, one on the second conjunct.

Experiment 1: movement and in-situ of the first conjunct

- acceptability judgment on a 100 point scale
 1. Who *t* fry indomie with oil last night ah? (short | non-island)
 2. What Sarah fry *t* with oil last night ah? (move | non-island)
 3. Sarah fry what with oil last night ah? (situ | non-island)
 4. Who *t* fry indomie and chicken last night ah? (short | island)
 5. What Sarah fry *t* and chicken last night ah? (move | island)
 6. Sarah fry what and chicken last night ah? (situ | island)
- 18 test items (3 per condition), 36 filler items, 4 check items, n = 29,

Experiment 1: movement and in-situ of the first conjunct

1. Who *t* fry indomie with oil last night ah? (short | non-island)
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 5. What Sarah fry *t* and chicken last night ah? (move | island)
 6. Sarah fry what and chicken last night ah? (situ | island)
- Four conditions were analyzed to test CSC effect on wh-movement

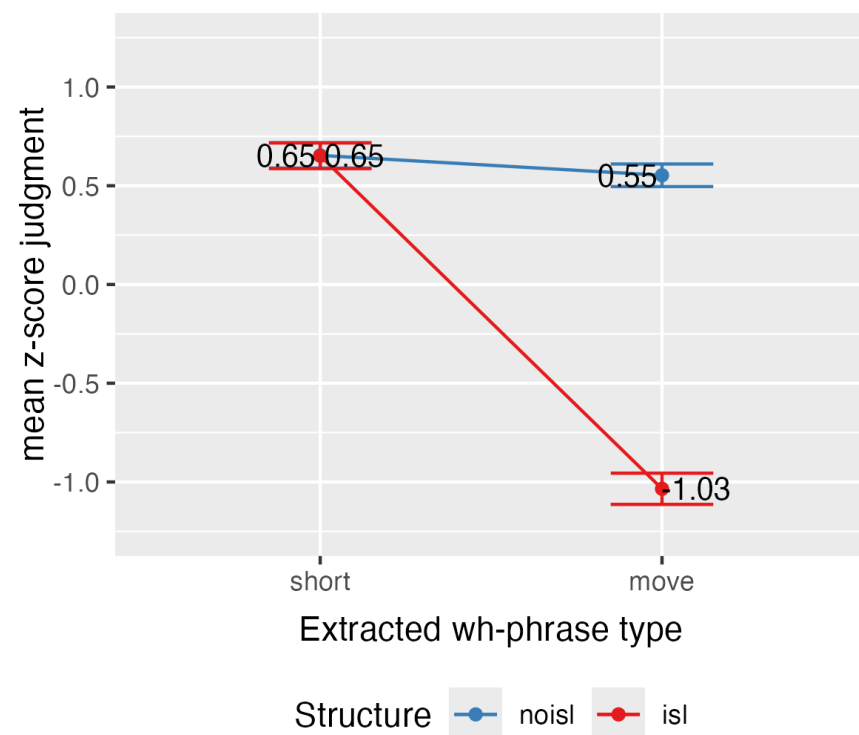
Experiment 1: movement and in-situ of the first conjunct

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- Four conditions were analyzed to test CSC effect on wh-in-situ

Experiment 1: movement and in-situ of the first conjunct

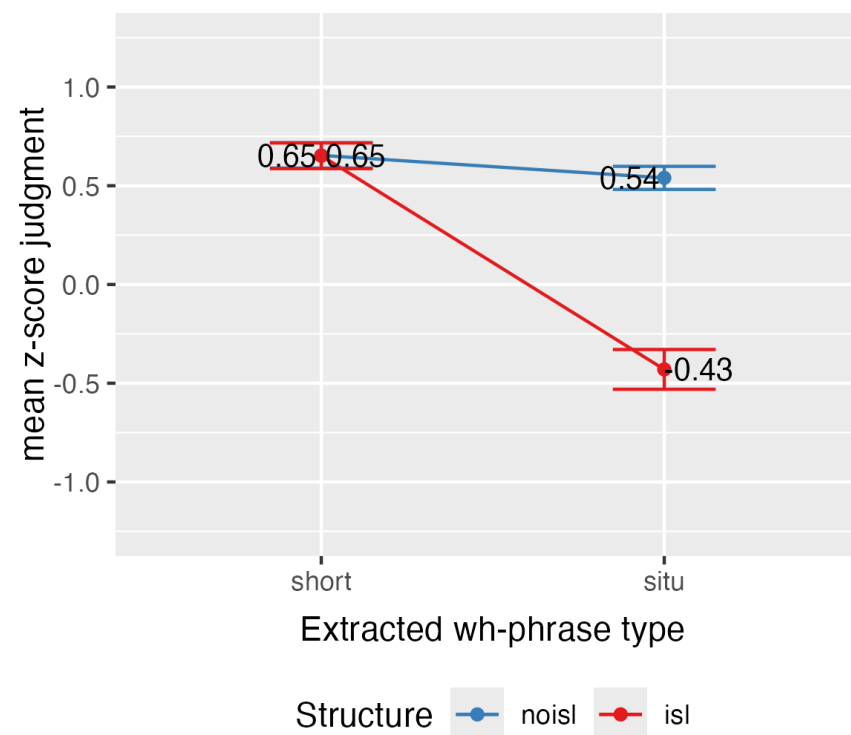
What Sarah fry *t* and chicken ah?

- short vs. move ($p < .0001$)



Sarah fry *what* and chicken ah?

- short vs. situ ($p < .0001$)



- Evidence for CSC in both wh-movement and wh-in-situ.

Experiment 2: movement and in-situ of the second conjunct

- same procedure, n = 29

1. Who *t* fry indomie with oil last night ah? (short | no-island)
2. What Sarah fry indomie with *t* last night ah? (move | no-island)
3. Sarah fry indomie with what last night ah? (situ | no-island)
4. Who *t* fry indomie and chicken last night ah? (short | island)
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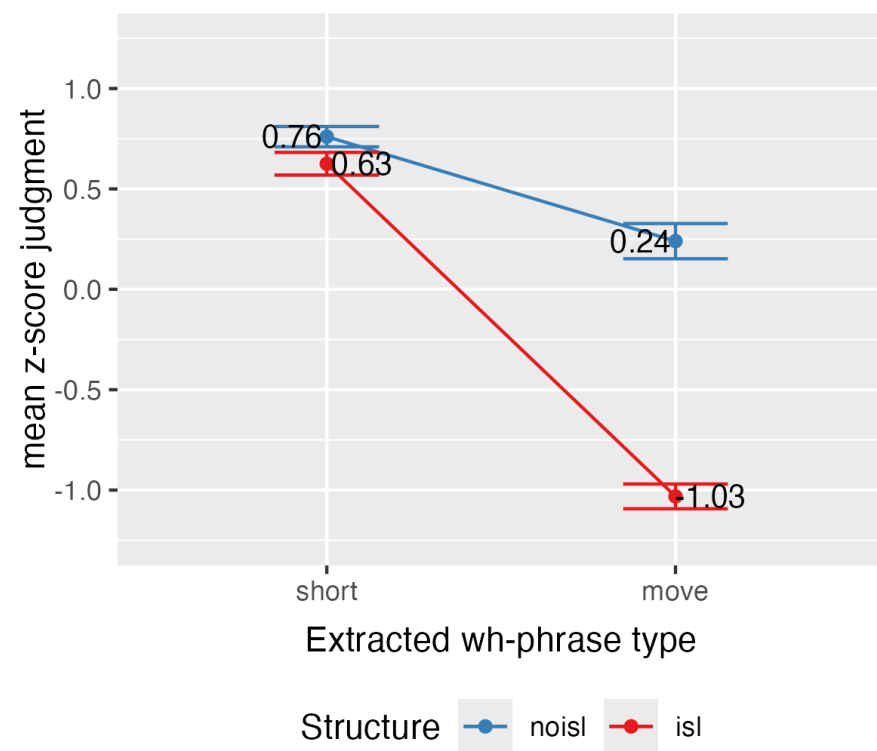
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- Four conditions were analyzed to test CSC effect on wh-in-situ

Experiment 2: movement and in-situ of the second conjunct

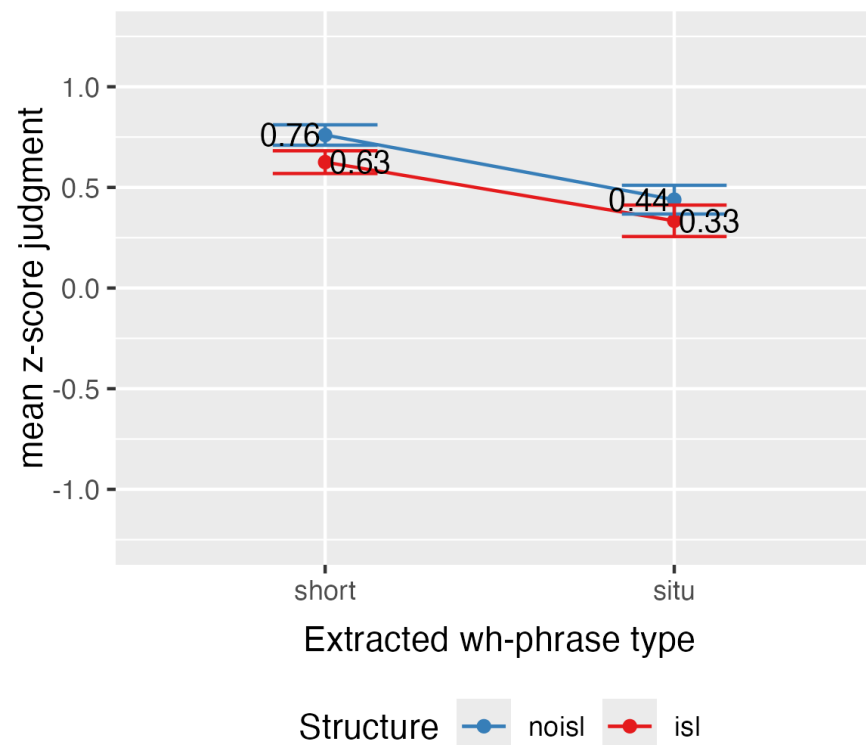
What Sarah fry indomie and *t* ah?

- short vs. move ($p < .0001$)



Sarah fry indomie and *what* ah?

- short vs. situ ($p = 1$)



- Evidence for CSC in wh-movement **but not** wh-in-situ.

What about wh-in-situ: experiments

Results:

- Wh-movement of both the first and the second conjunct show CSC effect.
- Wh-in-situ of the first conjunct shows CSC effect while wh-in-situ of the second conjunct does not.

18) *What Sarah fry and chicken ah? (*wh-movement of C1)

19) *What Sarah fry indomie and ah? (*wh-movement of C2)

20) *Sarah fry *what* and chicken ah? (*wh-in-situ of C1)

21) Sarah fry indomie and *what* ah? (wh-in-situ of C2)

What about wh-in-situ: predictions (repeated)

- The Parallelism Requirement:
 - If wh-element is [+wh], wh-in-situ of either conjunct is ruled out:
 - [-wh and +wh] or [+wh and -wh]
 - If wh-element is not [+wh], wh-in-situ should be OK: [-wh and -wh]
- Zhang 2010:
 - If wh-in-situ is covert movement:
 - wh-in-situ of the first conjunct should be bad (Category Transfer)
wh-in-situ of the second conjunct should be OK
 - If wh-in-situ is not movement (e.g. unselective binding):
 - wh-in-situ of the both conjuncts should be OK

What about wh-in-situ: predictions (repeated)

- The Parallelism Requirement:
 - If wh-element is [+wh], wh-in-situ of either conjunct is ruled out: (not supported)
 - [-wh and +wh] or [+wh and -wh]
 - If wh-element is not [+wh], wh-in-situ should be OK: [-wh and -wh] (not supported)
- Zhang 2010:
 - If wh-in-situ is covert movement:
 - wh-in-situ of the first conjunct should be bad (Category Transfer) (supported)
 - wh-in-situ of the second conjunct should be OK (supported)
 - If wh-in-situ is not movement (e.g. unselective binding):
 - wh-in-situ of the both conjuncts should be OK (not supported)

What about wh-in-situ: predictions (repeated)

- Zhang 2010:
 - If wh-in-situ is covert movement:
 - wh-in-situ of the first conjunct should be bad (supported)
 - wh-in-situ of the second conjunct should be OK (supported)
- But I just spent the first part of the talk arguing against the category transfer approach.
- And I argued against covert movement approach to wh-in-situ based on the absence of (other) island effects (Shen and Huang 2026, Shen and Chan 2025)...

What about wh-in-situ: very tentative suggestion

- Is there a way to account for the results in a theory where wh-in-situ is unselective binding and CSC is due to the Parallelism Requirement? **Maybe.**
- CSC effects on wh-movement of both conjuncts are predicted by the Parallelism Requirement.
- Absence of CSC effects on wh-in-situ of the second conjunct is predicted if one assumes that wh-elements in Singlish is not [+wh] (given the indefinite use).
- **Puzzle:** CSC effects on wh-in-situ of the first conjunct.

What about wh-in-situ: very tentative suggestion

- **Puzzle:** CSC effects on wh-in-situ of the first conjunct.
- Could this effect reflect a restriction on unselective binding in general?
 - $*OP_i \dots [C1_i \text{ and } C2]$
 - $OP_i \dots [C1 \text{ and } C2_i]$
- It's unclear why this would be the case.
- It would predict that wh-indefinite shows the same pattern:
 - 22) 我還以為你買了一部小說和哪本傳記呢。
I thought you bought a novel and which biography.
 - 23) 我還以為你買了哪本傳記和一部小說呢。
I thought you bought which biography and a novel.
Intended: I thought you bought some biography and a novel.

Summary (again)

- Experiments in Singlish show wh-in-situ of the first conjunct is bad while wh-in-situ of the second conjunct is OK.
- This is not expected from the Parallelism Requirement analysis
- The unacceptability of wh-in-situ of C1 could result from a general pattern with predictions for wh-indefinite.

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Thank you!